

MILIND SHELTE

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their inner workings. While the participation of more companies from Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities was a bright spot, a matter of concern for Nagaraj was the absence of deep tech companies, the ones at the centre of new, fundamental inventions who are looking for a different kind of risk capital.

Among other key SPJIMR programmes is one on family businesses and inculcating the 'maker mindset' where students are trained to build something of their own. Meanwhile, the international exchange programme has been expanded to include 150 students (from around 20 when Nagaraj took over).

The dean admits that teaching is a challenge in these times of high AI adoption in most spheres. But what sets the institute apart is the experience faculty members bring to the table. "Knowledge isn't just about knowing facts, it's about how you adapt it, incorporate it into what you do to get the desired outcome. That is what matters," says Nagaraj. "Use AI by all means, but the creation of knowledge, the acquisition of skills, and the inculcation of the right attitude—that is the job of the educator today."

GURUSPEAK



DR VARUN NAGARAJ
Dean, SPJIMR, Mumbai

"Knowledge is adapting facts to what you do to get a desired outcome.... We need friction in the classroom, so that you can learn in spite of AI, not because of it"